

Project Charter: Restaurant Discovery & Promotion App

1.0 PROJECT IDENTIFICATION

Project Name	HostIt
Description	Develop a functional prototype of a two-sided restaurant discovery and promotion application that helps customers discover local restaurants using customizable search criteria while providing restaurants with tools to manage their information and promote offers to potential customers.
Sponsor	MCDA 5510 Instructors
PMs	Sam & Armaan
Charter Date	October 7

1.1 PROJECT BACKGROUND

Consumers searching for local restaurants often rely on multiple sources to compare location, cuisine, price, ratings, and current promotions. Restaurant information and promotional offers may be fragmented across search engines, restaurant websites, social media, and third-party platforms. HostIt is intended to explore a centralized approach in which customers can discover and compare restaurants while restaurants can manage their information and promote offers through the same platform.

2.0 PROJECT SCOPE

The project will design and develop a functional prototype of a two-sided restaurant discovery and promotion app. The customer side will allow users to browse, sort and filter restaurants, as well as see deals and specials. The business side will allow restaurant owners to manage their profile and simulate the purchase of promotions that then appear in the customers' search. The project will also include the supporting database and application logic needed to store restaurant and business information.

2.1 The scope of the project DOES NOT include:

- Reservation making or table-booking.
- Food ordering or delivery, or integration with ordering/delivery platforms.
- A point-of-sale or payment processing system.
- Integration with every third-party review or mapping.
- Commercial deployment.
- Maintenance or upgrades after project completion.

3.0 KEY PROJECT DELIVERABLES

- Project requirements and system design documentation.
- Customer-facing interface.
- Restaurant/business-facing interface.
- Restaurant database.
- Restaurant discovery functionality, including search, sorting, and filtering.
- Business profile functionality, including simulated promotional purchasing.
- Promotional mechanics.
- Final functional prototype/demo.

4.0 PROJECT MILESTONE DATES

Target Date	Event / Milestone
October 7	Project charter approved
October 14	Full requirements and software design
October 14	Local restaurant database
October 21	Customer interface
October 28	Business interface
November 4	Search, sorting, and filtering for restaurant discovery
November 11	Business tools
November 18	Promotional mechanics
November 25	Demo compiled
December 4	Final system testing, bug fixes, documentation, and project demonstration

5.0 PROJECT ASSUMPTIONS

We assume the following to be considered true and certain:

- A sufficient sample of restaurant data will be available to develop and test the prototype.
- Customers will have access to the internet and location services when using distance-based restaurant discovery features.
- Restaurant owners will be responsible for maintaining the accuracy of information entered or updated through their business profiles.
- Restaurant owners will be able to claim or access their restaurant profiles through an alternative system.
- The prototype may simulate the purchase of promotional placements rather than process real commercial transactions.
- The restaurant dataset used for the prototype will be sufficiently representative to demonstrate search, sorting, filtering, and promotional functionality.
- Project team members will remain available throughout the planned development period.

6.0 PROJECT CONSTRAINTS

The project is limited by the following constraints:

- The project must be completed within the academic-project timeline.
- The project has no dedicated budget for paid APIs, commercial datasets, or other paid development services.
- The availability, completeness, and accuracy of restaurant data may limit the size and quality of the prototype database.
- Free third-party APIs and data sources may impose limitations on available data, functionality, or usage.
- The small project team limits the number and complexity of features that can be developed and thoroughly tested.
- Customer accounts, business accounts, and location-based functionality introduce privacy and security requirements that must be considered during development.
- The project is limited to a functional academic prototype and will not include the infrastructure, testing, security, or operational support required for commercial deployment.

7.0 CRITICAL SUCCESS FACTORS

The following factors will be used to determine whether the project objectives have been achieved:

- A functional prototype is completed and demonstrated by the final project deadline.
- Customers can successfully browse restaurants and sort or filter results using the core criteria of distance, cuisine/type, price, and rating.
- Customers can view restaurant profiles containing the information required by the prototype.
- Customers can view deals and promotional restaurant placements through the customer interface.
- Restaurant users can successfully access and update their restaurant profiles through the business interface.
- Restaurant users can create or select promotional placements through the business interface using simulated payment functionality.
- The database successfully stores, updates, and retrieves the restaurant, account, and promotional information required by the prototype.
- All defined core customer and restaurant workflows can be completed during final system testing without critical errors.
- The final prototype is completed within the agreed project scope, schedule, and available resources.

8.0 PROJECT STAKEHOLDERS

External

- Customers using the application to discover restaurants and offers.
- Restaurant owners and staff using the business interface.

Internal

- MCDA 5510 instructors.
- Sam and Armaan.

8.1-8.4 PROJECT GOVERNANCE

8.1 Sponsor MCDA 5510 stakeholders: responsible for approving the project charter and major changes to project scope, schedule, or objectives, and for determining whether the project has met its academic requirements.	8.3 External Steering Committee For the academic prototype, a formal external steering committee is not required. Sam and Armaan will fill the role.
8.2 Internal Steering Committee MCDA 5510 instructors: provide academic oversight and guidance and may assist in resolving significant project issues, scope questions, or other roadblocks requiring decisions beyond the project team's authority.	8.4 Project Team Sam and Armaan: day-to-day planning, requirements analysis, UI/UX design, database design, software development, testing, documentation, and preparation of the final demonstration and presentation. Specific responsibilities may be divided among team members based on technical skills and project needs.

9.0 SIGNOFF

Authorization to Proceed

Program Sponsor: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____